matter as the real rather than apparent transformation of one aspect of the Supreme Being (***Brahman***) that has become subject to limiting conditions (***upadhi***). The ***Brahman*** is both the underlying (*upadana-karana*) and instrumental (*nimitta-karana*) causes of the universe. His philosophy is called ***bheda-abheda-vada*** or the theory that the cosmos is differentiated while its source is unitary. Individual selves, subject to restricted awareness, the workings of ***karma*** and rebirth are emanations of the Supreme Being. They are comparable to sparks from fire. In defence of his position against the charge that conditioning by limits introduces imperfection into the godhead, *Bhaskara* uses a simile: just as atmosphere contained in a jar is different from the whole atmosphere in that the former is limited and the latter unrestricted and unconnected with the properties in the jar, similarly, defects occurrent in the embodied soul, differentiated and conditioned by limiting adjuncts, do not really affect the ***Brahman***.

Against non-dualist ***Vedanta*** he argues that if the world of differences and agency are just products of beginningless, primal ignorance (***avidya***), then we have no grounds for thinking that monistic belief is true since it too occurs in the sphere of ***avidya***.

The individual souls' desires for worldly things causes their bondage to rebirth. Transformation of desire into devotional meditation (*bhakti*) upon the Supreme Being brings about liberation. The agency of the embodied soul is real, although 'borrowed' from ***Brahman***, its ultimate source. Against the renunciatory (***samnyasa***) outlook characteristic of ***Advaita-Vedanta***, *Bhaskara* holds that the scripturally prescribed duties (***dharma***) appropriate to caste and stage of life always apply. Performance of ritual duties combined with understanding of the